

SC 4221
WASSCE 2026
ENGLISH
LANGUAGE 1
Objective Test
1 hour

1

Name

Index Number

THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

West African Senior School Certificate Examination
for School Candidates

SC 2026

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1
OBJECTIVE TEST

1 hour

Do not open this booklet until you are told to do so. While you are waiting, read and observe the following instructions. Write your name and index number in the spaces provided above.

1. Use **2B** pencil throughout.
2. On the pre-printed answer sheet, check that the following details are **correctly** printed:
 - (a) In the space marked **Name**, check your **surname** followed by your **other names**.
 - (b) In the spaces marked *Examination, Year, Subject and Paper*, check 'WASSCE (SC)', '2026', ENGLISH LANGUAGE', and '1' in that order.
 - (c) In the box marked *Index Number*, your **index number** has been printed vertically in the spaces on the left-hand side, and **each** numbered space has been shaded in line with **each** digit. **Reshade** each of the shaded spaces.
 - (d) In the box marked *Subject Code*, the digits 422113 are printed vertically in the spaces on the left-hand side. **Reshade** the corresponding numbered spaces as you did for your index number.
3. An example is given below. This is for a male candidate whose name is Tony Mensah ATIAH. His index number is 7102143958 and he is offering *English Language 1*.

THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

ANSWER SHEET

PRINT IN BLOCK LETTERS	
Name: ATIAH TONY MENSAH	GHA
Examination: WASSCE (SC)	Year: 2026
Subject: ENGLISH LANGUAGE	Paper: 1

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Use grade 2B pencil throughout.
2. Answer each question by choosing one letter and shading like this: ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
3. Erase completely any answer you wish to change.
4. Leave extra spaces blank if the answer spaces provided are more than you need.
5. Do not make any markings across the heavy black marks at the right hand edge of your answer sheet.

INDEX NUMBER										SUBJECT CODE											
7	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	4	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	2	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
0	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	2	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
2	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
4	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	3	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
3	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9											
9	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9											
5	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9											
8	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9											

For Supervisors only

If candidate is absent
shade this space

Answer **all** the questions.

Each question is followed by four options lettered **A** to **D**. Find the **correct** option for each question. Shade in **pencil** on your answer sheet the answer space which bears the same letter as the option you have chosen. Give only **one** answer to each question. Be sure you understand the instructions that follow them. Do not spend too much time on a question. If you find a question difficult, leave it and go and try it again later.

Use pencil throughout. If you wish to change an answer, erase your first answer completely and shade the appropriate space for the new answer.

An example is given below:

From the words lettered **A** to **D**, choose the word that **best** completes the sentence.

Advertisers use various means to entice buyers to purchase their goods.

- A. expectant
- B. prospective
- C. suitable
- D. prosperous

The correct answer is **prospective**, which is lettered **B**, and therefore answer space **B** would be shaded.

☐ A ☒ B ☐ C ☐ D

Do **all** rough work in this question paper.

Now answer the following questions.

PART A

LEXIS AND STRUCTURE

SECTION I

In **each** of the following sentences, there is a word underlined and one gap. From the list of words lettered **A** to **D**, choose the word that is **most nearly opposite** in meaning to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, **correctly fill** the gap in the sentence.

1. The police officers exposed the pistols the criminals had hidden under the seats of the car.
 - A. concealed
 - B. covered
 - C. protected
 - D. veiled
2. The students who went to town without exeats pleaded for leniency but the disciplinary committee acted
 - A. accurately
 - B. brutally
 - C. decisively
 - D. harshly
3. That sullen atmosphere in the house suddenly turned upon the announcement of Daddy's victory in the elections.
 - A. exuberant
 - B. exciting
 - C. brilliant
 - D. bright

4. Kafui stalked the animal all night but it all his efforts.
 - A. closed up
 - B. evaded
 - C. shook off
 - D. rejected
5. Baaba's recent publications on climate change are more fascinating than the ones she did earlier.
 - A. drab
 - B. educative
 - C. brief
 - D. insensitive
6. Adu's audacious demand for an apology from Mrs Ntim, the company CEO, was surprising since he was always
 - A. bold
 - B. cautious
 - C. respectful
 - D. quiet
7. Our workers complained about the hot and energy-sapping sun; a rest under the shade will be
 - A. absorbing
 - B. fascinating
 - C. revitalizing
 - D. welcoming
8. Mr Osei taught his sons to exhibit gallant gestures towards ladies not ones.
 - A. cowardly
 - B. disrespectful
 - C. insensitive
 - D. tactless
9. Amina wore a gorgeous dress to the party; she changed into a/an one immediately she got home.
 - A. dry
 - B. dirty
 - C. indecent
 - D. unattractive
10. He was an amateur boxer until he turned a/an then he travelled outside.
 - A. authority
 - B. expert
 - C. professional
 - D. trainer

SECTION II

From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that best completes each of the following sentences.

11. The obituary described the deceased owner of the most successful company in the industry as a
 - A. colossus
 - B. dynamite
 - C. middling
 - D. sensation
12. Sule should know where Ibrahim is he is his friend.
 - A. but
 - B. in case
 - C. since
 - D. thus

Turn over

13. Korkor is good singing, not swimming.
 A. at
 B. for
 C. in
 D. with
14. Ato's mother cautioned him to return the car
 A. blameless
 B. faultless
 C. spotless
 D. stainless
15. The parcel is for you and
 A. I
 B. me
 C. my
 D. myself
16. The load wasn't too heavy to carry,?
 A. didn't it
 B. isn't it
 C. has it
 D. was it
17. Atongo was planning a tour of the city my sister arrived.
 A. how
 B. where
 C. when
 D. which
18. Jane told her students there will be no assignment for the holiday they turn in their project work.
 A. as
 B. because
 C. provided
 D. since
19. We haven't yet decided on to go for the holidays.
 A. which
 B. where
 C. whom
 D. why
20. If it rains well this year, we have a bumper harvest.
 A. could
 B. might
 C. will
 D. would

SECTION III

Choose from the alternatives lettered **A** to **D** the one which is nearest in meaning to the underlined word or expression in **each** sentence.

21. There has never been any rift between the two villages over land ownership.
 A. argument
 B. conflict
 C. criticism
 D. insult

22. ✓ She left the village for the city to live a more ostentatious life.
A. fanciful
B. flamboyant
C. impressive
D. romantic
23. All political prisoners have been reprieved by the new regime.
A. pardoned
B. rebuked
C. retried
D. warned
24. Amma advanced a strong argument to refute the charge against her.
A. debate
B. disagree with
C. protest against
D. reject
25. Adherents of various religions must emulate their leaders.
A. equalize
B. imitate
C. protect
D. resemble
26. Buildings located in waterways in the city have been demolished to prevent flooding.
A. damaged
B. destroyed
C. levelled
D. smashed
27. The tourists were totally drenched by the heavy rain.
A. bathed
B. beaten
C. saturated
D. washed
28. It was her first experience, but Rakia handled the machine with great dexterity.
A. care
B. control
C. force
D. skill
29. Nancy's responses to the lawyer's questions were precise.
A. blunt
B. accurate
C. explicit
D. short
30. Despite Daniel's sterling achievements, he always acts modestly.
A. humbly
B. meekly
C. politely
D. shyly

SECTION IV

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of all or part of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation you consider most appropriate for each sentence.

31. The new phone she bought is common, it is practically ten a penny. This means the phone is not
 - A. expensive.
 - B. good.
 - C. sizeable.
 - D. special.
32. Prosper's final year students went belly up in the mock examinations. This means they in the exams.
 - A. cheated in
 - B. dodged
 - C. failed
 - D. passed
33. The police were ready to go for the arrest at the drop of a hat. This means the police would act
 - A. brutally.
 - B. decisively.
 - C. mercilessly.
 - D. instantly.
34. Akosua was made to bite the bullet and learn a trade to support the family. This means she was made to
 - A. abandon her education.
 - B. accept a difficult situation.
 - C. marry early in life.
 - D. take care of the family.
35. Peter was red in the face after tripping in front of the entire school during the assembly. This means he was
 - A. scared.
 - B. confused.
 - C. embarrassed.
 - D. surprised.
36. Philip's dedication to the project speaks for itself. This means his dedication is
 - A. acceptable.
 - B. obvious.
 - C. powerful.
 - D. remarkable.
37. The players made a spectacle of themselves when they were thrashed seven goals to one. This means the players themselves.
 - A. blamed
 - B. entertained
 - C. consoled
 - D. ridiculed
38. The volunteers did a yeoman's job in cleaning up the park a few minutes after the picnic. This means the volunteers did a work.
 - A. complete
 - B. thorough
 - C. quick
 - D. valuable

39. My sister and I are two peas in a pod when it comes to the choice of clothes. This means my sister and I
 A. argue constantly.
 B. are fraternal.
 C. like the same things.
 D. oppose each other.
40. When Johnson found out that his group hadn't completed their part of the project, he blew up at the meeting. This means he became
 A. angry
 B. desperate
 C. destructive
 D. frustrated

SECTION V

In the following passage the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below the passage, four choices are offered in columns lettered A to D. For each numbered gap, choose from the options provided for that number, the word that is most suitable to fill the gap.

Football, often regarded as the world's most popular sports, demands not only physical strength but also mental discipline and strategic —41—. A successful match depends on a team's ability to maintain possession, deliver accurate passes and execute well-timed —42—. The midfielder plays a crucial role in linking the —43— and forwards, ensuring a smooth transition from defense to attack.

During a competitive fixture, the —44— is expected to capitalize on every opportunity to score, often using swift counterattacks and precise finishing. Meanwhile, the goalkeeper, remaining the last line of defense, is responsible for making critical saves and organizing the —45—. To prevent goals, defenders must remain vigilant, employing strong marking and effective —46—. On the field, —47— such as corners, penalties and free kicks often prove decisive, particularly in closely contested matches. In such moments, planning —48— among players is vital. The —49— that excel typically exhibit excellent ball control, tactical awareness and a strong sense of —50—.

	A.	B.	C.	D.
41.	co-ordination	co-operation	arrangement	planning
42.	struggles	moves	attacks	tackles
43.	offenders	defenders	backwards	contenders
44.	striker	assailant	dribbler	captain
45.	back line	defense	front line	offence
46.	tricks	throw-outs	kick outs	clearance
47.	rehearsal-pieces	set-pieces	masterpieces	regular-pieces
48.	linkages	shouting	communication	discussion
49.	teams	groups	troupe	squad
50.	membership	community	teamwork	friendship

PART B
LITERATURE

Answer 30 questions in this part: 10 questions on Prose, 10 questions on Drama and 10 questions on Poetry.

PROSE

Answer any set of 10 questions numbered 51 to 60 in either Section I or Section II.

SECTION I

NON-AFRICAN PROSE

STEVENSON, ROBERT L.: *Treasure Island*

Read the following extract and answer questions 51 to 54.

First point: ... we must go on, because we can't turn back... second point, we have time before us..., until this treasure's found. Third point, there are faithful hands.

51. The speaker is
- Jim Hawkins
 - the Captain
 - the Doctor
 - John Silver
52. The tone of the speaker shows his
- persistence.
 - excitement.
 - disappointment.
 - indifference.
53. *We* refers to the
- sailors.
 - pirates.
 - merchants.
 - mutineers.
54. The underlined portrays the speaker as
- indifferent
 - exceptional
 - pessimistic
 - optimistic

Read the following extract and answer questions 55 to 58.

And with that, this brave fellow turned his back directly on the cook... With a cry, John seized the branch of the tree, whipped the crutch... and sent that uncouth missile hurtling through the air. It struck poor... point foremost, and with stunning violence, right between the shoulders in the middle of his back.

55. The character who was struck is
- Alan.
 - Redruth.
 - Gunn.
 - Tom.
56. The underlined is an example of
- metaphor
 - personification
 - metonymy
 - litotes

57. The extract portrays John as
- A. vengeful.
 - B. uncouth.
 - C. uncivilized.
 - D. merciless.
58. ... *stunning violence* is an example of
- A. alliteration
 - B. assonance
 - C. oxymoron
 - D. personification

Read the following extract and answer questions 59 to 60.

Marooned three years ago, he continued and lived on goats since then, and berries and oysters. Wherever a man is, says I, a man can do for himself.

59. The speaker is
- A. Jim Hawkins.
 - B. Ben Gunn.
 - C. John Silver.
 - D. Captain Flint.
60. The speech evokes a feeling of
- A. self-pity.
 - B. confidence.
 - C. sadness.
 - D. self-love.

SECTION II
AFRICAN PROSE
WOLO, MAMLE[®]: *The Kaya Girl*

Read the following extract and answer questions 51 to 54.

She gave a shy smile to show she did not intend to be rude, lowered the large metal bowl. I smiled back and, suddenly, language did not seem to be important. It was as if we knew each other already.

51. *Language did not seem important* because the two characters were able to communicate
- A. clearly.
 - B. non-verbally.
 - C. aggressively.
 - D. softly.
52. When *she* is not named until later, the writer keeps the reader in
- A. suspense.
 - B. fear.
 - C. anxiety.
 - D. doubt.
53. *She* is eventually revealed as
- A. Faiza
 - B. Abena
 - C. Auntie Lydia
 - D. Auntie Omotola

54. The narrator in the extract is
- A. Gifty.
 - B. Mike.
 - C. Abena.
 - D. Stephen.

Read the following extract and answer questions 55 to 56.

I imagined that if we had put it on my head instead, my whole neck would have been pushed down into my chest and my knees would have collapsed into my feet.

55. The dominant figure of speech in the extract is a
- A. symbol.
 - B. conceit.
 - C. paradox.
 - D. hyperbole.
56. The speaker is
- A. Gifty
 - B. Abena
 - C. Lydia
 - D. Asana

Read the following extract and answer questions 57 to 60.

I turned, in which direction I hardly knew, searching for her anywhere, everywhere, in shops, at food stalls, in all the places we had been together, but I couldn't find her ... but I didn't feel like going back to the shop... I felt as if I wanted to run away from myself.

57. The general feeling expressed in the extract is
- A. annoyance.
 - B. anger.
 - C. anxiety.
 - D. frustration.
58. The *I* refers to
- A. Faiza
 - B. Asana
 - C. Abena
 - D. Gifty
59. ... *I wanted to run away from myself* is an example of a/an
- A. hyperbole.
 - B. metaphor.
 - C. paradox.
 - D. oxymoron.
60. In the underlined, *her* refers to
- A. Faiza.
 - B. Asana.
 - C. Abena.
 - D. Gifty.

Answer any set of 10 questions numbered 61 to 70 in either Section I or Section II.

SECTION I
NON-AFRICAN DRAMA
IBSEN, HENRIK: *An Enemy of The People*

Read the following extract and answer questions 61 to 64.

- X: It is tremendously kind of you, ... , but I really cannot understand the necessity for all these precautions. It seems to me that the thing should go of itself.
- Y: The authorities are somewhat slow to move, Doctor. Far be it from me to seem to blame them.

61. The speakers, X and Y are respectively.

- A. Thomas and Morten
- B. Peter and Aslaksen
- C. Thomas and Aslaksen
- D. Peter and Morten

62. X's speech shows that he is

- A. temperamental
- B. crafty
- C. trusting
- D. generous

63. Y's speech can be described as

- A. hyperbolic.
- B. ironical.
- C. paradoxical.
- D. metaphorical.

64. The underlined is a

- A. letter.
- B. memo.
- C. minute.
- D. report.

Read the following extract and answer questions 65 to 68.

Q: We are going to stir them up in the paper tomorrow

65. The speaker, Q is

- A. Horster
- B. Aslaksen
- C. Morten
- D. Hovstad

66. The paper is

- A. The Brochure
- B. a letter
- C. The Herald
- D. a research

67. The addressee is
 A. Aslaksen.
 B. Morten.
 C. Eilif.
 D. Peter.
68. ... *stir them up* will be done through
 A. demonstrations.
 B. strikes.
 C. The Brochure.
 D. The Herald.

Read the following extract and answer questions 69 to 70.

Petra: But, father, tell us what it is

Dr Stockmann: Yes, yes, - only give me time, and you shall know all about it. If only I had Peter here now! It just shows how we men go about forming our judgements when in reality we are as blind as moles.

69. Dr Stockmann was saying that the Baths are
 A. too expensive
 B. unhygienic and unsafe
 C. not profitable
 D. not managed well
70. The underlined is an example of a
 A. personification.
 B. simile.
 C. hyperbole.
 D. metaphor.

SECTION II

AFRICAN DRAMA

MARSHALL, BILL : *The Son of Umbele*

Read the following extract and answer questions 61 to 65.

Not enough. I don't mind telling you that. You have love and imaginations, but that is not enough. Mind you, I do appreciate it. You put a smile on Duella's face. I could hear singing this morning as she went about her morning chore. The first time she has ever done so without cursing anyone. Chea, I hope she goes on laughing for a long time. We're all going to be grateful to you.

61. The speaker's tone is one of
 A. mockery.
 B. respect.
 C. excitement.
 D. indifference.
62. Duella's singing in the morning symbolizes her
 A. detachment from society.
 B. hatred for her brothers.
 C. triumph over superstition.
 D. love for domestic chores.
63. The addressee is
 A. a disruptive character.
 B. a helper to Duella.
 C. a mate to Duella.
 D. an aggressive character.

64. Later events show that the expression underlined is a/an
- irony.
 - oxymoron.
 - metaphor.
 - paradox.

65. Duella is the speaker's
- cousin
 - worker
 - friend
 - sister

Read the following extract and answer questions 66 to 70.

You build a great wall around you and when that is finished you ask yourself: 'Why can't I get out? I want to get out. I want to get out! I want some fresh air ... You are long time dead.'

66. The speaker is
- Sumako
 - Benko
 - Joshua
 - Duella
67. The speaker is talking to
- Duella.
 - Joshua.
 - Zekey.
 - Attu.
68. What prompts this speech is that the speaker city life.
- adores
 - endorses
 - misses
 - abhors
69. The underlined creates a feeling of
- uncertainty
 - desperation
 - sadness
 - disappointment
70. The repetition of *I want to get out* is for
- empathy.
 - emphasis.
 - rhythm.
 - rhyme.

Answer any set of 10 questions numbered 71 to 80 in either Section I or Section II.

SECTION I
NON-AFRICAN POETRY

OWEN, WILFRED: *Anthem for Doomed Youth*

71. The poem
- A. highlights the ills of war.
 - B. talks about the benefits of war.
 - C. paints a picture of a soldier in a war.
 - D. eulogizes those who die through war.
72. In the line, *monstrous anger of the gun*, the figure of speech used is
- A. personification.
 - B. synecdoche.
 - C. metonymy.
 - D. euphemism.

WHITMAN, WALT: *I Sit and Look Out*

73. The diction suggests that the poet
- A. is afraid to die.
 - B. is eager to explore life.
 - C. has many obsessions.
 - D. has good observational skills.
74. The poem depicts
- A. loss of belief.
 - B. real life experiences.
 - C. lack of commitment.
 - D. dreamlike sequences.

DONNE, JOHN: *Batter My Heart*

75. The first line, *Batter my heart, three person'd God* is a/an
- A. oxymoron.
 - B. alliteration.
 - C. apostrophe.
 - D. personification.
76. The first four lines rhyme
- A. ABAB.
 - B. ABBA.
 - C. ABCD.
 - D. ABCC.

LAWRENCE, D.H: *Piano*

77. The flow of the poet's nostalgic feeling is conveyed by the
- A. end-stopped lines
 - B. continuous tense
 - C. past tense
 - D. run-on lines
78. What triggers the poet's feeling is
- A. *the vista of years.*
 - B. *the winter outside.*
 - C. *my manhood.*
 - D. *the glamour of childish days.*

MCKAY, CLAUDE: *If We Must Die*

79. The poem is composed of
 A. three quatrains and a couplet.
 B. two quatrains and a sestet.
 C. an octave and a sestet.
 D. an octave and two tercets.
80. The simile in *let it not be like hogs* evokes a feeling of
 A. lightness.
 B. carelessness.
 C. senselessness.
 D. mockery.

SECTION II AFRICAN POETRY

MTSHALI, OSWALD: *Nightfall in Soweto*

.... Clasp the dagger
 strikes down the helpless victim

71. *The helpless victim* is
 A. anybody
 B. somebody
 C. the poet
 D. the poor
72. The dominant image in the poem is one of
 A. violence.
 B. deceit.
 C. racism.
 D. misfortune.

AWOONOR, KOFI: *The Weaver Bird*

73. The persona sees Christianity as a/an
 A. very powerful religion
 B. wicked man's religion
 C. unsympathetic religion
 D. invading religion
74. In the poem, the persona expresses displeasure about the
 A. difference between Christianity and African traditional religion.
 B. harm that Christianity caused to Africa.
 C. houses that Europeans built in Africa.
 D. destruction of African homes by Europeans.

CLARK, JOHN PEPPER: *Night Rain*

We will settle to sleep of the innocent and free

75. A literary device used in the line above is
- A. onomatopoeia.
 - B. metaphor.
 - C. alliteration.
 - D. assonance.
76. The extract suggests that the persona and his family are fed up with their situation but
- A. will not talk about it.
 - B. cannot do anything about it.
 - C. have overcome it.
 - D. indifferent to their plight.

RUBADIRI, DAVID: *An African Thunderstorm*

77. The third stanza of the poem uses diction.
- A. narrative
 - B. expository
 - C. argumentative
 - D. descriptive
78. The dominant literary device used to portray the force of the storm is
- A. alliteration.
 - B. consonance.
 - C. assonance.
 - D. onomatopoeia.

OKARA, GABRIEL: *Once Upon a Time*

79. The dominant mood of the poem is that of
- A. melancholy.
 - B. excitement.
 - C. uncertainty.
 - D. anger.
80. The theme of the poem is the
- A. joy of being young.
 - B. attractions of old age.
 - C. loss of traditional values.
 - D. difficulties of modern living.

END OF PAPER

SC 4222
WASSCE 2026
ENGLISH
LANGUAGE 2
Essay
2 hours 30 minutes

2

CANDIDATE'S NAME	
INDEX NUMBER	SIGNATURE
DATE:	

THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

West African Senior School Certificate Examination
for School Candidates

SC 2026

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2

2 hours 30 minutes

ESSAY

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- In the spaces provided above, insert your name, full index number, normal signature and the date of examination.*
- This booklet consists of four sections; A, B, C and D. Answer four questions in all, choosing one question each from sections A and B and all the questions in sections C and D.*
- Write the question number and your index number at the top of each page.*
- Write on both sides of the paper unless otherwise instructed on the question paper.*
- Begin each answer to a question on a fresh page. Leave two lines between answers where there are sub-questions to the same question.*
- On no account should you tear off any part of the booklet. It is an examination malpractice to do so. The answer booklet will be collected at the end of the examination.*
- Write in the space provided below, the number of the questions you have answered in the order in which you have written them.*

For Examiner's Use Only	
Question Number	Mark
TOTAL	

Answer four questions in all: choose one question each from sections A and B, and all the questions in Sections C and D.

SECTION A

GENERAL ESSAYS [40 marks]

Answer one question only from this section.

All questions carry equal marks. Your answer should not be less than 450 words.

You are advised to spend about 50 minutes on this section.

1. Write a letter to your father telling him about a programme you have decided to offer at the university. Discuss **three** reasons for your decision.
2. You are the principal speaker in a debate organized by your school on the motion, *The Teacher comes first among all other Professionals*. Write your arguments **for** or **against** the motion.
3. A non-governmental organization (N.G.O) has decided to offer assistance to your school. Write a letter to the Director of the N.G.O discussing **three** projects you expect them to do for the school. Give reasons for your selection.
4. Robbery with violence has become frequent in your district in recent times. Write an article suitable for publication in a national newspaper discussing **three** causes of this problem and suggesting what should be done to curb it.
5. Write a story which begins, *I thought I was going to win the prize easily*.

SECTION B FUNCTIONAL WRITING [20 marks]

Answer one question only from this section.

All questions carry equal marks. Your answer should not be less than 250 words.

You are advised to spend about 30 minutes on this section.

6. You are the secretary to your school's Old Students Association and you attended a meeting a week ago. Write minutes for the meeting.
7. During a friendly football match between your school and a sister school, a conflict broke out. As the sports prefect, write a report on the conflict.

3
SECTION C
COMPREHENSION
[20 marks]

You are advised to spend about 30 minutes on this section

8. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

The case between Kaka and his boss, Tinto, has just begun. "My job as an auditor, Your Honour, is to check income and expenditure. I examine vouchers, take inventories and look for discrepancies in accounts. In short, I analyze facts and figures and finally submit reports together with comments and recommendations. I should also mention that the profession of being an auditor is not the type that helps to win friends. It tends rather to create enemies, and I did make many enemies while carrying out my duties. But I did not, on that account, shirk my responsibilities or degrade my profession. I did my auditing and submitted my reports to the man I am now accused of having attempted to murder, Tinto.

If he had any doubts of the correctness of my reports, he could have invited me or external auditors to double check the accounts and clarify the matter further. He could even have deducted from my salary the external auditors' fee if they found any discrepancies in my work. But he did nothing of the sort, Your Honour. He just shelved the reports and remained unconcerned while thefts and embezzlements were going on in the corporation under his control.

My other duty was to process all kinds of tenders from contractors, one of which was for the supply of articulated trucks involving not less than four million dollars. I executed this work together with my colleagues who were members of the committee *which I had the honour to chair*. After we had done our duty on this matter in strict adherence to the laid-down policy, we were told without any explanation to reject the tender we had approved. We objected to this in the interest of the corporation. What happened to me as a result, Your Honour? I have been dismissed and humiliated.

Fitting into what was considered 'the norm' wasn't easy for me. Wedging myself into the sort of lifestyle a large majority of other employees resorted to wasn't easy either. Now they want to confer on me the sharp feeling of humiliation? If ever they succeed in their quest, then I am not Kaka, son of the Lion."

"I have been disgraced and humiliated," Kaka echoed, as his voice lowered to a whisper, his finger numb. The judge had heard enough. He never sought to clarify the matter.

- (a) What is the charge against Kaka?
- (b) What is the relationship between Kaka and Tinto?
- (c) State the two audit cases in which Kaka failed to receive proper support from Tinto.
- (d) What is the attitude of Kaka to corruption?
- (e) Provide evidence to show that Tinto did not actually question the accuracy of Kaka's reports.
- (f) *Wedging myself into the sort of lifestyle ...*
What figure of speech is used in this expression?
- (g) *... which I had the honour to chair.*
 - (i) What is the grammatical name of this expression as it is used in the passage?
 - (ii) What is its function?

- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as used in the passage:
- (i) discrepancies;
 - (ii) recommendations;
 - (iii) shirk;
 - (iv) clarify;
 - (v) tenders;
 - (vi) executed.

SECTION D
SUMMARY
[30 marks]

You are advised to spend about 40 minutes on this section.

9. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

Many people consider bees a nuisance. On the contrary, bees play a vital role in the lives of plants and humans. They are noted for their love for flowers and feared for their sting. These insects impact our environment in several ways. The presence of bees is an indicator of environmental health and their decline can signal broader ecosystem issues; that is, bee keeping promotes environmental conservation of natural ecosystems. When bee population starts to reduce, it is rarely just about the bees – it is an indication of danger regarding the health of the entire environment. Bees are highly sensitive to environmental toxins. A rapid decline in their number at a particular place often points to an overuse of pesticides and herbicides.

Beekeeping provides an opportunity to harvest honey, a nutritious food with various health benefits. The honey is used in traditional medicine, cosmetics, and food production.

A high number of people in our country generate income from beekeeping. Quality honey used by people who wish to avoid the use of sugar comes from beekeeping. Thus, good income is generated from the project of beekeeping. Apart from honey, beeswax and other bee products are sources of income. They can be valuable opportunities for rural communities or small-scale farmers. Research in the Berekum Municipality of the Bono West Region of Ghana reveals that beekeeping contributes 23% to 49% of a household's total annual income, acting as a critical safety net when crops fail.

As we continue to enjoy the sweet sap that we get from beekeeping, we must not forget the sting and allergic reactions caused by bees. The sting can be painful and potentially life-threatening for individuals with allergies. I remember an incident in which our school prefect was stung on his upper lip by one of those small insects. His lip got swollen and became as big as an inflated balloon for days. Beekeepers need to take precautions and be prepared for emergencies.

Bee colonies can be vulnerable to diseases, pests and environmental stressors leading to colony losses. These colony losses can have a rather adverse effect on the entire ecosystem. For instance, pollination of plants suffers thereby affecting crop yield. As a result of the dangers associated with beekeeping, it is not engaged in without observing precautionary measures. It requires significant time and labour commitment, particularly during peak seasons. Beekeepers necessarily need to regularly inspect their colonies, harvest honey and perform other tasks to maintain healthy bees. This can be challenging for individuals with busy schedules.

In fact, individuals can make informed decisions about whether beekeeping is right for them. With the right knowledge, skills and precautions, beekeeping can be a rewarding and sustainable venture.

- (a) In **three** sentences, **one** for **each**, summarize the benefits of beekeeping.
- (b) In **two** sentences, **one** for **each**, summarize the challenges associated with beekeeping.

END OF PAPER